4-Year Computer Science Academic & Professional Development Success Plan (180 Credits to Graduate)

1. STUDENT PROFILE & ADVISING INFORMATION

Student Name: _____ **NLU Student ID:** _____

NLU Email: _____ **Date:** _____

Current Class Standing (select one): ☐ Year 1 (Freshman) ☐ Year 2 (Sophomore) ☐ Year 3 (Junior) ☐ Year 4 (Senior) ☐ Transfer

Current Credits Earned: _____ / 180 QH **Remaining Credits Needed:** _____ QH

Target Graduation Term/Year: _____

Assigned NLU Student Success Coach: _____ **CSS 100 Instructor:** _____

2. CONCENTRATION AREA & MANDATORY CAPSTONE / INTERNSHIP REQUIREMENT

Declared / Intended Concentration Area: _____

> **Policy Note:** Freshmen and Sophomores **MUST officially declare** their Computer Science Concentration Area before entering Junior and Senior year (Year 3 / Year 4). Additionally, all B.S. Computer Science students **MUST complete** either **CAR 490 (Internship Practicum)** or **CAR 492 (Capstone Project)** prior to graduation.

Culminating Requirement Selection: ☐ CAR 490 (Internship Practicum) ☐ CAR 492 (Capstone Project)

Target Term: _____

3. OPTIONAL COURSERA CERTIFICATE COURSE SUBSTITUTIONS

Students may optionally earn approved Coursera Professional Certificates and include them in their plan to substitute for corresponding NLU courses (coordinate with NLU Success Coach and Prior Learning Assessment).

Include?	Coursera Certificate	NLU Course Substituted	Credits (QH)	Target Completion Term	Verification / Coach Initials
☐	Google IT Support Professional Certificate	CSS 210	5 QH	_____	_____
☐	Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate	CSS 300	5 QH	_____	_____
☐	Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate	CSS 400	5 QH	_____	_____
☐	Google UX Design Professional Certificate	CSS 303	5 QH	_____	_____
☐	Google Project Management Professional Certificate	CSS 315	5 QH	_____	_____

Total Coursera Substitution Credits Planned: _____ QH

4. 4-YEAR QUARTERLY ACADEMIC ROADMAP (180 QUARTER HOURS)

Map courses across Fall, Winter, and Spring quarters for Years 1–4 (typically 15 QH per quarter = 45 QH/year; 180 QH total required for B.S. graduation). Each year includes an **Optional Summer Quarter** for students who want to accelerate and graduate early, plus space to slot in Coursera substitutions and **CAR 490/492**.

YEAR 1 (Freshman)			
Fall Quarter	**Winter Quarter**	**Spring Quarter**	**Optional Summer Quarter (Early Graduation)**
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Quarter Total: _____ QH	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**

YEAR 2 (Sophomore — Declare Concentration Before Year 3)			
Fall Quarter	**Winter Quarter**	**Spring Quarter**	**Optional Summer Quarter (Early Graduation)**
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Quarter Total: _____ QH	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**

YEAR 3 (Junior)			
Fall Quarter	**Winter Quarter**	**Spring Quarter**	**Optional Summer Quarter (Early Graduation)**
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Quarter Total: _____ QH	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**

YEAR 4 (Senior — Must Complete CAR 490 or CAR 492)			
Fall Quarter	**Winter Quarter**	**Spring Quarter**	**Optional Summer Quarter (Early Graduation)**
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Cr:	Cr:	Cr:	Cr:
Quarter Total: _____ QH	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**	**Quarter Total: _____ QH**

Graduation Credit Summary: Year 1 QH: _____ + Year 2 QH: _____ + Year 3 QH: _____ + Year 4 QH: _____ + Transfer/Coursera QH: _____ = **Total: _____ / 180 QH**

5. PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN (PDP)

Professional Development Plan Instructions: Please use this template to build your professional development plan. Be sure to be as specific as possible when you are building this plan. For target dates you should consider deadlines within 3-4 years maximum. Some skills and certifications may take a long time to achieve and that's ok! Be sure to prioritize both short-term and long-term goals as well as the support(s) you will need.

- ☐ At least three (3) technical/professional skills beyond what you will learn in the program.
- ☐ At least two (2) industry certifications beyond what you will achieve in the program.
- ☐ At least two (2) substantive projects that you will develop that relate to your career.
- ☐ At least one (1) way to host/showcase these projects (e.g., learning Git + GitHub, portfolio site).
- ☐ Any other career, networking, hackathon, or leadership goals beyond those mentioned above (optional).

Skills / Tasks / Certifications to Achieve What are the items necessary to ensure that you are ready to succeed in your desired career? Specify priority: Short-Term vs. Long-Term	**Target Dates** When will you achieve these goals? Within 3–4 years max	**Support Needed** What support(s) will you need from yourself, your family, friends, professors, and NLU staff to succeed in these goals?
Skill #1:		
Skill #2:		
Skill #3:		
Certification #1:		
Certification #2:		
Career Project #1:		
Career Project #2:		
Project Hosting Platform (e.g., Git + GitHub):		
Optional Goal:		

6. COMPUTER SCIENCE CAREER MATCH & POST-GRADUATION BLUEPRINT

Concentration / Focus Area: _____

Top 2 Target CS Career Roles: 1) _____ **2)** _____

Recommended Certifications & Hosting Platforms for Target Career:

_____

_____

How I Will Utilize My B.S. in Computer Science After Graduation (technical skills, CAR 490/492 experience, portfolio):

_____

_____

_____

Post-Graduation Action Plan (Months 0–12 & Years 1–3: job search strategy, networking, graduate study, advanced certifications):

_____

_____

_____

_____

7. NLU STUDENT SUCCESS COACH LOOP-IN & SIGN-OFF

☐ Scheduled advising meeting with NLU Student Success Coach to review 180 QH roadmap.
☐ Verified Concentration Area declaration deadline (prior to Year 3/4) and CAR 490/492 eligibility.
☐ Reviewed Coursera certificate substitutions (CSS 210 / CSS 300 / CSS 400) and PDP milestones with Coach.

Coach Notes / Advising Feedback:

_____

_____

_____	_____	_____
Student Signature & Date	**NLU Student Success Coach Signature & Date**	**CSS 100 Instructor Review & Date**